



ETHEREUM'S WHITEPAPER

019 / 27 NOV 2013 / ETHEREUM / EPIC

MORE THAN JUST MONEY.

A manuscript lies open beneath a warm desk lamp. Its writing faces the young developer, while its far edge lifts into a violet-lit structure of folded platforms and tiny figures. An idea is acquiring space around it. The studio is imagined, but the paper at its centre marks a real change in what a blockchain might become.

Ethereum's official timeline dates its introductory whitepaper milestone to 27 November 2013. In his January 2014 account, Vitalik Buterin recalled writing the initial draft in San Francisco that November. This card marks that early proposal, before the public announcement and well before Ethereum's network launched in July 2015. The later canonical whitepaper is commonly dated 2014.

The ambition was a shared platform on which developers could write many kinds of application. Rather than building separate infrastructure for each new feature, they could express rules through a general-purpose programming language. The small diagram on the page turns that idea into a branching path. The card's phrase comes from Buterin's own early explanation: more than just money.

The paper cat, unicorn and ghost let the illustration look forward. They refer to CryptoKitties, Uniswap and Aave, applications that would belong to Ethereum's later ecosystem. None is presented as already running in 2013. Between the pencil and the glowing diamond, the scene connects a draft with possibilities that other builders would eventually explore.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE PAPER CAT

A folded kitten points forward to CryptoKitties and collectible digital cats. It is an intentional future reference, perched within the emerging paper world.

02 THE PAPER UNICORN

The horn and pink-lit folds reference Uniswap. Its place on a shared platform suggests one application among many.

03 THE PAPER GHOST

The small figure with dark eyes nods to Aave's ghost mascot. Like the cat and unicorn, it belongs to the scene's imagined future.

04 THE ETHEREUM DIAMOND

The faceted paper form identifies the emerging ecosystem. It is a retrospective visual symbol, not a documented object on the original writing desk.

05 ONE IDEA, MANY BRANCHES

A single box connects to different output shapes. The manuscript faces Vitalik, so its writing appears upside down to the viewer.

06 DRAFTS IN THE TRAY

The spare copies suggest the proposal being shared. Physical paper circulation is a visual metaphor, not a reconstruction of how it was distributed.

07 THE FRONTIER DOORWAY

The distant unfinished opening hints at the later network launch. It is a collection foreshadowing device, not a documented feature of the room.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Ethereum's timeline supplies the milestone date; Buterin's January 2014 account supplies the draft recollection and phrase. The room, paper layout and sculpture are imagined. The three app figures and doorway deliberately look ahead; this is not a documentary reconstruction or a facsimile of the original draft.